

Pao de Queijo

Ingredients

1 cup grated Parmesan cheese
300gms ricotta, crumbled
1 cup full fat milk
1/4 cup vegetable oil, plus
1 Tbsp for oiling your hands
2 eggs
500gms tapioca flour also known as tapioca starch
2 tsp kosher salt

Directions

Step 1:

Prepare the Dough: Preheat oven to 175C.

Step 2:

Add the tapioca flour and the salt to a large bowl, whisk to combine and set aside.

Step 3:

In a medium bowl, combine the cheeses and the eggs and set aside.

Step 4:

Add the milk and the oil to a small saucepan and bring to a simmer on stove top over medium heat.

Step 5:

When the liquid simmers, remove the pan from heat, and immediately pour the hot liquid into the tapioca mixture and using a wooden spoon, stir to combine – the mixture will not be homogeneous, it'll be gummy and clumpy.

Step 6:

Wait 5-10 minutes until the tapioca mixture is cool to touch, and only then add the cheese and egg mixture to the tapioca mixture. Mix with a wooden spoon, or your hands to combine. Now you should have a homogeneous mixture and it should come together as a ball. You'll still see some white tapioca specks in the dough – don't worry, that's totally normal!

Roll the Little Balls:

Oil your hands, then scoop a Tbsp to 2Tbsp size portions, roll them into balls, and arrange them in a baking sheet approximately 2" apart from one another. Bake until golden brown, approximately 30-35 minutes.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

The Colony Shopping Centre, 345 Jan Smuts Avenue, Craighall, 2024.

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JAMAICAN CHICKEN CURRY

INGREDIENTS

2 tablespoons (2 tablespoons) Oil
1 tablespoon (1 tablespoon) Minced Ginger
1 tablespoon (1 tablespoon) Minced Garlic
1 cup (160 g) onions, chopped
1.5 tablespoons (1.5 tablespoons) Jamaican Curry Powder
1 Scotch Bonnet Pepper, sliced
3 sprigs Fresh Thyme, or 1/2 teaspoon Dried Thyme
1 teaspoon (1 teaspoon) Kosher Salt
1/2 teaspoon (0.5 teaspoon) Ground Allspice
500gms Boneless Skinless Chicken Thighs, cut into 3 pieces each
1 Potatoes, large, cut into 1-inch chunks
1 cup (250 ml) Water

METHOD

Step 1

Heat a large pot or saute pan over medium heat, once hot add the oil.

Step 2:

When the oil is hot, add ginger and garlic, and stir for 20 seconds.

Step 3:

Add chopped onion and mix well, cook until the onions have softened up (about 1-2 minutes).

Step 4:

Add the Jamaican curry powder, the sliced scotch bonnet pepper, thyme, salt and allspice and mix well.

Step 5:

At this point, if you have any browning or sticking that has occurred, use 1/4-1/3 cup of water to deglaze, scraping well, and allowing the water to evaporate.

Step 6:

Add chicken, potato, and 1-2 cups of water, stir well and then simmer on medium heat for about 20-30 minutes covered, checking and adding liquid as required.

Step 7:

Once the potatoes are cooked and the chicken is tender remove from the heat. Check and adjust seasoning.

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JAMAICAN CURRY POWDER

BLEND

INGREDIENTS

2 teaspoons coriander
2 teaspoons fenugreek seeds
2 teaspoons turmeric
2 teaspoons cumin
2 teaspoons black pepper
1 teaspoon cinnamon
1 teaspoon bay leaf, dried
1 teaspoon fennel seed
1 teaspoon nutmeg
1/2 teaspoon clove
1/2 teaspoon ginger
1/2 teaspoon cayenne
1/2 teaspoon allspice
1/2 teaspoon cardamom

METHOD

Step 1

Grind all whole spices and seeds and bay leaves to a powder.

Combine all the ingredients and store in an airtight jar.

Note: While you can use pre-ground spices, the flavor is really better if you grind whole cloves, nutmeg, etc.

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JAMAICAN RUM CAKE

INGREDIENTS

For the cake

2 cups all-purpose flour, sifted
1/4 cup corn starch
1/4 cup powdered milk
4 teaspoons baking powder
1 teaspoon salt
1/3 cup unsweetened shredded coconut
1 1/2 cups natural granulated sugar
1/2 cup unsalted butter, softened
3/4 cup unsweetened coconut milk, canned 4
extra large eggs
1/2 cup dark spiced rum, or dark rum
1 tablespoon vanilla extract
1 teaspoon almond extract
1 1/2 cups crushed pineapple, drained and
juices reserved for glaze (from 20 ounce can)
1/4 cup almond meal for dusting the pan
Nonstick cooking spray

For the Spiced Rum Syrup:

1/2 cup unsalted butter
1/2 cup natural granulated sugar
1/2 teaspoon salt
1/2 cup pineapple juice, reserved from can
1/2 cup spiced rum

For the Glaze:

1 1/2 cups powdered sugar (more as needed)
3 tablespoons pineapple juice, reserved from
can
1 teaspoon spiced rum

For the Topping:

1/2 cup sweetened shredded coconut

METHOD

Step 1

Preheat the oven to 325 degrees F. Spray a 12-cup bundt pan with nonstick cooking spray and dust with almond meal.

For the Cake:

Step 1:

With an electric mixer, beat 1/2 cup of softened butter with 1 1/2 cups of granulated sugar.

Step 2:

In a separate bowl mix all the dry ingredients together, including the shredded coconut. Then beat the dry mixture into butter mixture. It will be crumbly.

Step 3:

Whisk the coconut milk, eggs, rum, extracts, and drained crushed pineapple together, and add to the mixer. Beat until combined.

Step 4:

Pour the batter into the pan and bake for 55 minutes. Insert a toothpick into the center of the cake, if it comes out clean the cake is done. If not, bake for 5-10 minutes longer, then test again.

For the syrup:

While the cake is cooling, prepare the spiced rum syrup. In a sauce pan combine all ingredients. On medium heat, bring the mixture to a simmer and cook for 8-10 minutes until it begins to thicken slightly. Remove from heat.

With a wooden skewer, poke holes throughout the cake and slowly pour the syrup over it, a quarter cup at a time, allowing it to absorb until all the syrup has been applied.

Cover the pan loosely with plastic wrap and let it sit at room temperature for 6-8 hours.

When ready to serve, gently slide a thin knife between the cake and the edges of the pan to loosen. Cover the cake with a cake plate and carefully flip. Once your cake has released, remove pan.

Mix the glaze ingredients starting with 1 1/2 cups of powdered sugar, 2 tablespoons of pineapple juice, and rum. Whisk and add more powdered sugar or juice to reach your desired consistency. It should be very thick, yet still be able to slowly drip down the sides of the cake.

Toast the coconut in a small dry skillet, over medium heat. Stir until

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BAIGAN CHOKA

Trinidad & Tobago

INGREDIENTS

1 large firm eggplant roasted, peeled and pulp collected
2 medium ripe tomatoes roasted and peeled
1 small onion finely chopped
2 cloves of garlic freshly grated
1 habanero pepper/piri piri pepper or 2 green chilies chopped
1 tablespoon hot oil of choice or butter
Salt to taste
Lime juice and cilantro to garnish

METHOD

Step 1

Wash and dry the eggplant. Pierce the eggplant all over and then roast in the highest shelf of the oven at the highest temperature, until the skin is blackened and collapsing.

Step 2:

Place the tomatoes on an outdoor grill or under a grill heated to its highest and cook until the tomatoes become soft and roasted.

Step 3:

If using the habanero, you can either roast it or grill it. For green chilies, just use freshly chopped ones.

Step 4:

Peel the eggplant and tomatoes and transfer the pulp to a mortar and pestle or small food processor.

Step 5:

Add salt, freshly ground garlic, and chili pepper.

Mash all the ingredients really well until a creamy mass is formed.

Step 6:

Now add hot oil and mix well. Add chopped onions and garnish the dish with cilantro and lime juice. Serve immediately.

Step 7:

Serve with Trinidad flatbreads.

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BUSS UP SHUT - FLATBREAD

Trinidad

INGREDIENTS

330g flour
3/4 tsp baking powder 1/2 tsp salt
3/4 tsp sugar
180-220ml water (don't add all at once, it will depend on the flour used how much you need exactly)
Ghee (or clarified butter) - slightly melted or softened to make it easy to spread out over the dough surface
Flour for rolling

METHOD

Step 1

Mix the flour, baking powder, salt, and sugar. Add the water gradually to make a dough. The dough will be slightly sticky and very flexible. However, after some gentle kneading it should come clean off your hands. Knead the dough together until it comes together in a nice ball, don't knead it any further.

Step 2

Leave to rest for at least 15 minutes to relax the gluten.

Split the dough into 4 separate balls to make 4 paratha roti with a diameter of about 22cm each. Adjust the number of portions based on your pan size.

Step 3:

Roll out the dough in flat circles. It will be slightly sticky, so use ample flour.

Step 4:

Cover the dough with a thin layer of ghee, make sure to spread it out evenly.

Step 5:

Lightly dust the top with a little flour (this makes it easier to roll).

Step 6:

Now make a cut from the center of the dough circle to the outside and start rolling the dough from that cut in a circle to the other side of the cut (see image in the post). You will end up with a cone.

Ensure that the bottom doesn't have fat sticking out, stretch the outer layer of dough to cover the inner layers. Now push the pointy top of the cone inside to tighten and dust with some flour. Pushing it into the middle helps create all those dough layers!

Step 7:

Leave to rest for another 15-30 minutes, even better would be at least an hour. A longer resting period makes it easier to roll out the dough.

Step 8:

Heat a flat baking surface on a medium heat (e.g. using a tawa).

Roll out the balls of dough and bake on the flat surface on a medium heat. Coat the top with a thin layer of ghee (or clarified butter). When the top starts getting drier, turn the dough around. Again, cover the topside with a thin layer of ghee.

Step 9:

Towards the end, when the dough starts to be cooked through, take two spatulas and loosen the paratha by inwards pushing on the sides of the paratha. Due to all the rolling you should have made layers of dough with fat in between. By 'beating' the paratha and folding it together you help all the layers get loose and flaky.

You want the different layers to separate, so crinkle and beat until you see them coming apart. The paratha is ready once it has turned slightly brown and a loosened up structure.

ALOO CHOKA

Trinidad & Tobago

INGREDIENTS

4 large potatoes
2 tablespoon olive oil or mustard oil
1/4 red onion chopped fine
1/2 teaspoon salt
1 clove garlic finely minced or grated 1/4
green hot pepper Serrano or habanero
1 clove sliced garlic to temper
1/2 tsp cayenne pepper

METHOD

Step 1

Place the potatoes in a pot of boiling salted water, unpeeled and cook until the potatoes are just tender

Step 2:

Remove the potatoes from the pot, and let them cool down. Peel and mash them with a fork or potato masher.

Step 3:

Season with salt, hot pepper, and grated fresh garlic. Mix well. (You can also make a paste out of pepper and garlic and mix it with potatoes)

Step 4:

Now heat the oil in a pan and let it smoke. Now add sliced garlic pieces and hot cayenne pepper, switch off the gas, and drizzle this oil over the mashed potato or aloo Choka.

Step 5:

Now garnish the potato with chopped red onions and cilantro, and serve with lime juice.

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JAMAICAN SPICED JERK CHICKEN

INGREDIENTS

1 medium onion, coarsely chopped 3
medium scallions, chopped
2 Scotch bonnet chiles, chopped 2
garlic cloves, chopped
1 tablespoon five-spice powder
1 tablespoon allspice berries, coarsely ground
1 tablespoon coarsely ground pepper
1 teaspoon dried thyme, crumbled
1 teaspoon freshly grated nutmeg
1 teaspoon salt
1/2 cup soy sauce
1 tablespoon vegetable oil
Two 1,5kg chickens, quartered

METHOD

Step 1

In a food processor, combine the onion, scallions, chiles, garlic, five-spice powder, allspice, pepper, thyme, nutmeg and salt; process to a coarse paste. With the machine on, add the the soy sauce and oil in a steady stream. Pour the marinade into a large, shallow dish, add the chicken and turn to coat. Cover and refrigerate overnight. Bring the chicken to room temperature before proceeding.

Step 2:

Light a grill. Grill the chicken over a medium-hot fire, turning occasionally, until well browned and cooked through, 35 to 40 minutes. (Cover the grill for a smokier flavor.) Transfer the chicken to a platter and serve.

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NUTMEG ICECREAM

Grenada

INGREDIENTS

1 1/2 cups milk
1 1/2 cups heavy cream 3 large eggs
3/4 cup sugar
1 tablespoon grated fresh nutmeg (about 1 whole nutmeg)
1/8 teaspoon salt
1 teaspoon vanilla extract

METHOD

Step 1

In a saucepan bring the milk and the cream just to a boil. Do not boil but turn off the heat as soon as it gets to boiling stage.

Step 2:

In a bowl whisk together the eggs, the sugar, the nutmeg, the salt, and the vanilla.

Step 3:

Whisk 1/2 cup of the milk mixture into the egg mixture, and whisk the mixture into the remaining milk mixture.

Step 4:

Cook the custard over moderate heat, stirring constantly with a wooden spoon, until it registers 175 degrees F. on a candy thermometer.

Step 5:

Transfer the custard to a metal bowl set in a larger bowl of ice and cold water and stir it until it is cold.

Step 6:

Freeze the custard in an ice-cream maker according to the manufacturer's instructions.

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ARROZ CON POLLO

Puerto Rico

INGREDIENTS

For the chicken:

2 tablespoon olive oil, divided
600gms boneless skinless chicken thighs

For the adobo seasoning:

1 teaspoon cumin
3/4 teaspoon paprika
1/2 teaspoon chili powder
1/2 teaspoon red cayenne pepper 1/2
teaspoon onion powder
1/2 teaspoon garlic powder
1/4 teaspoon coriander
1/2 teaspoon salt
Freshly ground black pepper

For the sofrito & rice:

3 cloves garlic, minced
1/4 cup finely diced green pepper 1/4
cup finely diced white onion
1/4 cup finely diced cilantro
Optional: 1 jalapeno, diced
1/4 teaspoon ground coriander
1/4 teaspoon cumin
1/4 teaspoon ground turmeric
1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
1/4 teaspoon oregano
1/4 teaspoon salt
1/4 teaspoon black pepper
1 cup tomato sauce
1 1/4 cups water
1 cup basmati white rice 2/3
cup frozen peas

METHOD

Step 1

Add chicken to a large bowl. Add in 1 tablespoon olive oil and your adobo seasoning: cumin, paprika, chili powder, cayenne pepper, onion powder, garlic powder, coriander, salt and pepper. Use clean hands to toss the chicken in the mixture. Cover and allow chicken to marinate for 30 minutes, or you can skip this completely and begin the cooking process!

Step 2:

Next add remaining 1 tablespoon olive oil to a large deep 10 inch skillet and place over medium high heat. (If you do not have a skillet a large pot will also work very well!) Once oil is hot, add in chicken and season with a little more salt and pepper. Cook until browned 4-5 minutes, then flip and and cook an additional 4-5 minutes. Remove from pan and transfer to a plate.

Step 3:

In the same skillet (it should be greased enough already for sauteing) you will make your sofrito by adding in garlic, jalapeno, diced green pepper, diced onion and cilantro.

Step 4:

Saute for 2-3 minutes, then add in your spices (also known as homemade sazón spices): cumin, turmeric, coriander, garlic powder, oregano, salt and pepper and cook for 30 seconds. Then add in tomato sauce and water and stir well to combine.

Step 5:

Bring to a simmer then fold in the rice and peas, making sure it is evenly distributed. Add browned chicken on top.

Step 6:

Reduce heat to low, cover the skillet immediately and cook for 20-25 minutes.

Step 7:

After 20-25 minutes, most of the liquid should be absorbed and rice should be cooked. Serve immediately. Garnish with cilantro and serve with a squeeze of fresh lime juice.

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CARIBBEAN STEWED FISH

INGREDIENTS

For the fish:

1.5kg firm white fish – cleaned scaled and cut in steaks
½ teaspoon grated ginger
½- teaspoon white pepper
1 teaspoon minced garlic ½ teaspoon thyme
½ teaspoon minced garlic ½
teaspoon white pepper
½ teaspoons green seasoning optional
½ teaspoon chicken bouillon powder optional
1 lemon
Salt to taste

For the Stew

½ cup vegetable oil or more as needed
1 medium onion thinly sliced
1 teaspoon minced garlic about 2 garlic cloves
½ teaspoon ginger
1 teaspoon thyme
1 bay leaf
1 Scotch bonnet pepper pierced or replace with ½ teaspoon cayenne pepper
3-4 medium tomatoes diced
1 bell pepper sliced
2 green onions scallion chopped
Bouillon seasoning optional
White pepper or black as needed to taste

METHOD

Step 1

Rinse fish; carefully, drain, and pat dry with paper towels or a clean towel rub with lemon or lime.

Step 2:

Place fish in a large bowl or saucepan then season with salt, garlic, ginger, thyme, white pepper and green seasoning.

Mix fish with a spoon or with hands until they are well coated, set aside in the fridge and marinate for 30 minutes or overnight

When ready to cook remove fish fridge, lightly shake off any marinate sticking out.

Step 3:

In large skillet heat oil over medium heat, until hot, add the fish, cook each side- for about 2-3 minutes on both sides. Remove fish and set aside.

Step 4:

Drain oil and leave about 3 or more tablespoons of oil, if using the same pan or heat oil in the medium saucepan.

Step 5:

Then add onion, scotch bonnet pepper, garlic, green seasoning, thyme, bay leaf, sauté until onions are tender, about 2 minutes or more. Stir frequently to avoid any burns

Step 6:

Add tomatoes continue stirring and let it simmer for about 5 minutes or more with about ½ cup stock or water or more as needed.

Step 7:

Finally add bell pepper, green onions followed by fish one at time and more stock about ½ cup stock or water. Simmer for about 5 minutes or more. Adjust for seasonings and thickness of stew with stock or oil.

Step 8:

Remove and serve with rice

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GREEN SEASONING

INGREDIENTS

1 bunch of cilantro
1/2 bunch of parsley
4 scallions chives, chopped
1 head of garlic peeled
1 bunch of thyme about 8 sprigs
1 stalk of celery
2 pimento peppers
pinch of himalayan pink salt
1 small onion sliced
1/2 red bell pepper

METHOD

Step 1

Transfer all of the ingredients into a colander and rinse thoroughly. Place all of the ingredients into either a blender or food processor (if using food processor blitz on high speed until the bulk of the herbs have broken down into a coarse texture, remembering to pulse and scrape the sides).

Step 2:

If using a blender blitz until a puree is formed, feel free to add a tbsp or two of olive oil to help things move along quickly.

Step 3:

store in container in a cool place

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MEDIANOCHIE

INGREDIENTS

1 lb. pork loin
Salt and freshly ground black pepper 2
tbsp. olive oil
4 medianoche bread, or challah/brioche
1/2 cup yellow mustard
450gms sliced deli ham, halved
8 slices swiss cheese, halved
4 dill pickles
4 tbsp. unsalted butter, softened

METHOD

Step 1:

Heat oven to 400°. Season pork with salt and pepper and drizzle with olive oil. Place on a roasting tray and roast until a thermometer inserted reads 160°, about 45 minutes. Remove from oven and transfer to a cutting board to rest, about 15 minutes. Thinly slice the pork.

Step 2:

Halve the bread lengthwise and spread the insides of each roll with 1 tablespoon mustard. Divide the ham, pork, cheese, and pickles evenly among sandwiches.

Step 3:

Heat half the butter in a 12-inch skillet over medium. Working in batches, cook two sandwiches, pressing down on the top with a 10-inch cast iron skillet, until golden on the bottom, about 3 minutes. Flip the sandwiches over, press with the skillet, and continue cooking until the other side is golden brown and the cheese has melted, about 3 minutes more. Transfer to a cutting board and cut in half on the diagonal to serve.

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JAMAICAN RICE & PEAS

INGREDIENTS

2 tbsp olive oil
1 large onion (diced)
4 cloves garlic (minced)
1 tsp fresh ginger (grated)
1 tsp fresh thyme (chopped)
1 tsp salt
1 tsp freshly ground black pepper
1/2 tsp ground allspice
1 Scotch Bonnet chile (or Habanero), diced *)
1.75 cups water (or low-sodium chicken stock)
1 (13.5 ounce) can full-fat coconut milk
2 cups long-grain white rice
2 (15 ounce) cans red kidney beans (drained and rinsed)
Fresh lime juice (for serving (optional))

METHOD

Step 1:

Saute the aromatics. Heat the olive oil in a large sauté pot over medium-high heat. Add the onions and cook for 5-6 minutes, or until soft and translucent, stirring often to prevent burning.

Step 2:

Reduce heat to medium-low and add the garlic, ginger, fresh thyme, salt, pepper, ground allspice, and Scotch bonnet chile (or habanero). Mix well to combine. Stir continuously for 1-2 minutes.

Step 3:

Add the water and coconut milk. Add the water (or chicken broth) and coconut milk to the pot. Mix to combine and bring just to a boil. Add the rice. Stir in the rice, reduce heat to low, and cover.

Step 4:

Cook the rice until liquid is absorbed and rice is tender, checking every 5 minutes and gently fluffing with a fork as it cooks.

Step 5:

Remove from heat and add the beans. Remove pot from heat and gently stir in the drained and rinsed kidney beans. Cover and allow rice to rest for an additional 5 minutes before serving.

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JAMAICAN CABBAGE

INGREDIENTS

1 head cabbage
2 tablespoons olive oil, or as needed
1 small onion, thinly sliced
½ chopped green bell pepper
1 green onion, sliced
2 sprigs fresh thyme
1 whole Scotch bonnet chile pepper
1 teaspoon salt
1 cup shredded carrots
¼ cup white vinegar
2 tablespoons white sugar

METHOD

Step 1:

Peel tough outer leaves from cabbage, core the head, and shred cabbage.

Step 2:

Heat olive oil in a large skillet over medium high heat; Raise heat to high. Stir onion, green bell pepper, and green onion in the hot oil and cook until vegetables have softened, about 5 minutes, stirring often. Stir thyme, Scotch bonnet pepper, and salt into onion mixture.

Step 3

Mix shredded cabbage and carrots into onion mixture until thoroughly combined, cover skillet, and reduce heat to medium-low. Cook until cabbage has started to soften, about 10 minutes, stirring occasionally. Uncover skillet and stir vinegar and sugar into cabbage mixture; cook and stir until cabbage is tender, about 3 more minutes. Discard Scotch bonnet pepper and thyme sprigs before serving.

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BEIJINHOS

Ingredients

1 can of sweet condensed milk
1 cup of unsweetened, shredded coconut
1 tablespoon of butter plus a little more for your hands
1/4 cup of heavy cream
16 whole cloves for decorating optional

Method

1. Add the condensed milk, the butter, and the cream to a medium sauce pan and place it over medium heat until the butter melts.
2. After the butter has melted, add half of the shredded coconut (1/2 cup) to the pan and stir.
3. Continue to cook over medium heat, for approximately 10 mins, stirring repeatedly, scraping the sides and the bottom of the pan with a spatula to avoid burning.
4. The beijinho is ready when you scrape the bottom of the pan, and the mixture takes 2-3 seconds to come back to its place, or when the mixture reaches 99-104C – You can use a candy thermometer, or just a regular food thermometer to check.
5. Pour the hot coconut mixture into a dish, or plate, cover with plastic wrap to contact and let it cool – about 2 hours.
6. Meanwhile, pour the remaining shredded coconut in a deep plate or bowl.
9. When the beijinho mixture has cooled, butter your hands, and scoop 1/2 Tbsp to Tbsp portions and roll little balls.
10. Roll the little balls in the shredded coconut, and insert a whole clove to each little coconut ball to decorate, if desired.
11. Keep them in a cool place or in the refrigerator until serving time.

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PICADILLO CUBANO

INGREDIENTS

3 Tbsp olive oil
1 small onion, diced
½ green bell pepper, diced
2 cloves fresh garlic, pressed
750gms beef mince
1 tsp. Salt
½ tsp. Pepper
1 can (8 oz) tomato sauce
1 small can tomato paste ¼
cup dry white wine
4 Tbsp. Pimiento-stuffed green olives, sliced
¼ cup of dark raisins
½ tsp. Cumin
½ tsp. Oregano

METHOD

Step 1

Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Saute the onion, green pepper and garlic until the onion is translucent.

Step 2:

Add the ground beef and brown over medium heat.

Step 3:

Add the rest of the ingredients and continue cooking until meat is tender and completely cooked through.

About 25 minutes.

Step 4:

Serve over white rice

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CARIBBEAN SALSA

INGREDIENTS

2 cups fresh diced tomatoes (or canned when out of season)
1 onion finely chopped
1 teaspoon chopped garlic
1 tablespoon olive oil
1/2 teaspoon cumin, chili powder, curcuma, paprika. (each)
1 table spoon orange juice (or lime)
dash of honey
1/2 cup diced mango (or pineapple)
salt to taste

METHOD

Step 1
In a small pan warm the oil with spices and garlic over medium heat
Step 2:
Once fragrant , add onions, cook until just clear
Step 3:
Now add all other ingredients let simmer until salsa is thick enough, taste and adjust with a little salt.

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Medianoche

Ingredients

1 lb. pork loin
Salt and freshly ground black pepper
2 tbsp. olive oil
4 medianoche bread, or challah/brioche
1/2 cup yellow mustard
450gms sliced deli ham, halved
8 slices swiss cheese, halved
4 dill pickles
4 tbsp. unsalted butter, softened

Method

Step 1:

Heat oven to 400°. Season pork with salt and pepper and drizzle with olive oil. Place on a roasting tray and roast until a thermometer inserted reads 160°, about 45 minutes. Remove from oven and transfer to a cutting board to rest, about 15 minutes. Thinly slice the pork.

Step 2:

Halve the bread lengthwise and spread the insides of each roll with 1 tablespoon mustard. Divide the ham, pork, cheese, and pickles evenly among sandwiches.

Step 3:

Heat half the butter in a 12-inch skillet over medium. Working in batches, cook two sandwiches, pressing down on the top with a 10-inch cast iron skillet, until golden on the bottom, about 3 minutes. Flip the sandwiches over, press with the skillet, and continue cooking until the other side is golden brown and the cheese has melted, about 3 minutes more. Transfer to a cutting board and cut in half on the diagonal to serve.

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Chocolatõn

Ingredients

6 eggs (separate whites and yolks)
350gms semi-sweet chocolate chips
226gms butter
3/4 cup sugar
1 tsp. Vanilla

Method

Step 1

Melt the butter and chocolate chips together. This can be done on top of the stove in a double boiler, or in a microwave oven for about 1 1/2 minutes.

Step 2

Stir the melted chocolate and melted butter together until smooth.

Step 3

Whip the egg whites into a fluffy meringue.

Step 4

When the meringue starts to peak, add the sugar, bit by bit.

Step 5

Fold in the egg yolks.

Step 6

Add the (warm) chocolate mixture and the vanilla to the meringue.

Step 7

Gently blend together until it is completely mixed.

Step 8

Pour into a serving bowl or individual cups.

Step 9

Chill for at least an hour before serving.

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Picadillo Cubano

Ingredients

3 Tbsp olive oil
1 small onion, diced
½ green bell pepper, diced
2 cloves fresh garlic, pressed
750gms beef mince
1 tsp. Salt
½ tsp. Pepper
1 can (8 oz) tomato sauce
1 small can tomato paste
¼ cup dry white wine
4 Tbsp. Pimiento-stuffed green olives, sliced
¼ cup of dark raisins
½ tsp. Cumin
½ tsp. Oregano

Directions

Step 1

Heat the olive oil in a large skillet over medium heat. Saute the onion, green pepper and garlic until the onion is translucent.

Step 2:

Add the ground beef and brown over medium heat.

Step 3:

Add the rest of the ingredients and continue cooking until meat is tender and completely cooked through. About 25 minutes.

Step 4:

Serve over white rice and tostones.

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Esquites (Charred Corn Salad)

Ingredients

4 cups corn (about 5 ears)
1 tbsp olive oil
1/2 red bell pepper chopped
1/2 small red onion finely chopped
1/2 cup fresh cilantro chopped
6 spring onions chopped
1 jalapeno pepper diced
1/2 avocado chopped
4 tbsp lime juice (from about 2 limes)
1/2 tsp cumin ground
1/2 tsp smoked paprika
1/4 tsp black pepper ground
1/4 tsp salt
2 tbsp sour cream (or yogurt)
2 tbsp mayonnaise
1/2 cup feta, crumbled

Instructions

Step 1

Start by charring the corn over a hot braai or in a very hot griddle pan. Allow to cool until it can be handled, then cut the corn off the cob and set aside in a large bowl.

(You can also use canned corn or frozen corn. If using frozen, no need to thaw it out. You will need to char it in a very hot dry pan)

Step 2

Transfer the corn to a large bowl and let it cool for a couple minutes.

Step 3

To the same bowl, add the remaining ingredients. Stir everything together (excluding the diced avocado) until well combined. Now add the avocado, mix gently, taste and then adjust lime juice and salt and pepper as necessary.

Step 4

To serve garnish with additional cheese and cilantro, if preferred.

THE
COOKERY

by The Secret Jozi Chef

The Colony Shopping Centre, 345 Jan Smuts Avenue, Craighall, 2024.

www.facebook.com/secretjozichef

Mexican Chipotle Mussels

Ingredients

1 kg fresh mussels
1 medium onion, finely chopped
1 clove garlic, minced
2 tomatoes, chopped
1 jalapeno, deseeded and chopped (optional)
1/2 tbsp. olive oil
1 tsp. chipotle paste
1 x 330ml bottles of Corona or Sol beer
zest and juice of 1 or 2 limes, plus extra wedges to serve
crusty bread, to serve

Instructions

Step 1:

Heat 1tbsp oil and add the onions and fry until just softened, now add the chopped jalapeno and garlic, cook for 2 minutes until fragrant

Step 2:

Now add the chipotle paste and the chopped tomato and cook for 1-2 minutes.

Step 3:

Now add the beer and bring to a simmer, cook for 2 minutes before adding the mussels and covering with a tight fitting lid.

Step 4:

Stir in the lime zest and juice and check the seasoning. Divide among 4 soup bowls and serve with extra lime wedges and crusty bread to mop up the juices.

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SOPA DE ELOTE

INGREDIENTS

1/4 cup olive or vegetable oil

6 cups fresh corn kernels , from 8-10 shucked cobs (save 6 of the stripped cobs for simmering the soup)

1 cup chopped yellow onion

1/4 teaspoon chipotle powder or paste (use more or less, depending on your heat preferences)*

1/2 tsp paprika

1/2 tsp cumin

kosher salt and freshly ground black pepper

2 large garlic cloves , chopped (about 1 tablespoon)

4 cups chicken or vegetable broth

1/2 cup sour cream

1/2 cup grated dry/aged Cotija cheese , plus additional for garnish (substitute Parmesan or Romano if Cotija is unavailable)

1 tablespoon fresh lime juice

1 teaspoon grated lime zest

2 tablespoons plus 2 teaspoons chopped cilantro , divided

INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Heat oil in a large, nonstick pot or cast iron Dutch oven until shimmering. Add corn kernels, chopped onion, chili powder, cumin and parika, 1/2 teaspoon salt, and 1/2 teaspoon black pepper. Cook over medium-high heat, stirring frequently, until onions are soft and corn is lightly charred in spots, about 8-10 minutes.

Step 2: Add garlic and cook until fragrant, 1 minute. Remove 1-1/2 cups of corn mixture from the pot and set aside. Stir broth and 6 stripped corn cobs into the pot, scraping up the brown bits on the bottom. Bring to a boil, reduce heat, and simmer for 20 minutes.

Step 3: Use tongs to remove corn cobs from pot and discard.

Step 4: Stir sour cream and Cotija into the soup. Transfer soup to a blender or food processor (in batches, depending on the size of your unit for safety) to puree until smooth.

Step 5: Return soup to pot and if needed, gently reheat to desired serving temperature. Stir in half (3/4 cup) of the reserved corn mixture, lime juice, and 2 tablespoons chopped cilantro. Season to taste with salt, pepper, and chili powder.

Step 6: Toss remaining 3/4 cup corn with lime zest and 2 teaspoons chopped cilantro. Serve soup, topped with a few spoonfuls of the corn mixture, and an extra sprinkling of Cotija.

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